EXECUTIVE REPORT

Project Manager Selection Process · Meridian Digital

Companion to the recruiting dashboard · October 12, 2026

1. Executive summary

This report presents the results of a complete evaluation and selection process for the Project Manager role at Meridian Digital. 30 applicants were assessed across document/CV review, four psychometric instruments (cognitive ability, personality, integrity and vocational interests), two structured interviews and an assessment center. All evidence was consolidated into an interactive dashboard and a single weighted fit index (0-100) anchored to the role's target profile.

The process delivered measurable gains for the agency:

1. Higher expected fit than experience-based hiring: selecting the three candidates with the highest fit index (mean 90.2) instead of the three most experienced (mean 77.3) raises expected person-job fit by 12.9 points per hire (+17%).

2. Faster time-to-hire: a digitally delivered battery with automated scoring replaces a typically multi-week evaluation with a process completed in days.

3. Lower early-turnover risk: automated screening by the fit index flagged 8 of 30 applicants (27%) as clearly below the target profile, candidates who would likely have passed a CV-only screen.

This report complements the dashboard by detailing the results behind the numbers and closes with the selection recommendation: the three candidates recommended for hiring are Fernanda Aguilar (fit 91.7), Alejandra Perez (fit 73.6), Gabriela Perez (fit 82.3).

2. Business problem

The Project Manager is the node between client expectations, creative and media teams, budgets and delivery dates at Meridian Digital. A poor hire materializes as delayed campaigns, margin erosion, client churn and early attrition. This report is the written companion to the interactive recruiting dashboard: it details the results behind every number and closes with the recommendation of the three candidates to hire.

3. Methodology

A competency model for the role was defined from the job description (docs/job_description_PM.docx), producing explicit target zones per construct. Instruments: ICAR cognitive ability; IPIP-NEO-120 personality; Honesty-Humility integrity (HEXACO); O*NET Interest Profiler (RIASEC). Overall fit = cognitive 20% + personality 35% + integrity 20% + interests 15% + CV 10%; labels High >= 72, Medium 55-72, Low < 55.

4. Technology

• Python 3.12 · pandas · numpy · scipy · matplotlib

• Streamlit + Plotly (interactive dashboard, monospace black/white/gray theme)

• python-docx + reportlab (this deliverable) · Git/GitHub

5. Results

5.1 Applicant pool overview

30 applicants evaluated; fit index mean 68.4 (SD 13.7), range 42.8-91.7. High band: 14 (47%); Medium: 8; Low: 8.

5.2 Overall fit index

The fit index integrates five components into one auditable number; its spread confirms it discriminates across the slate rather than clustering at the top.

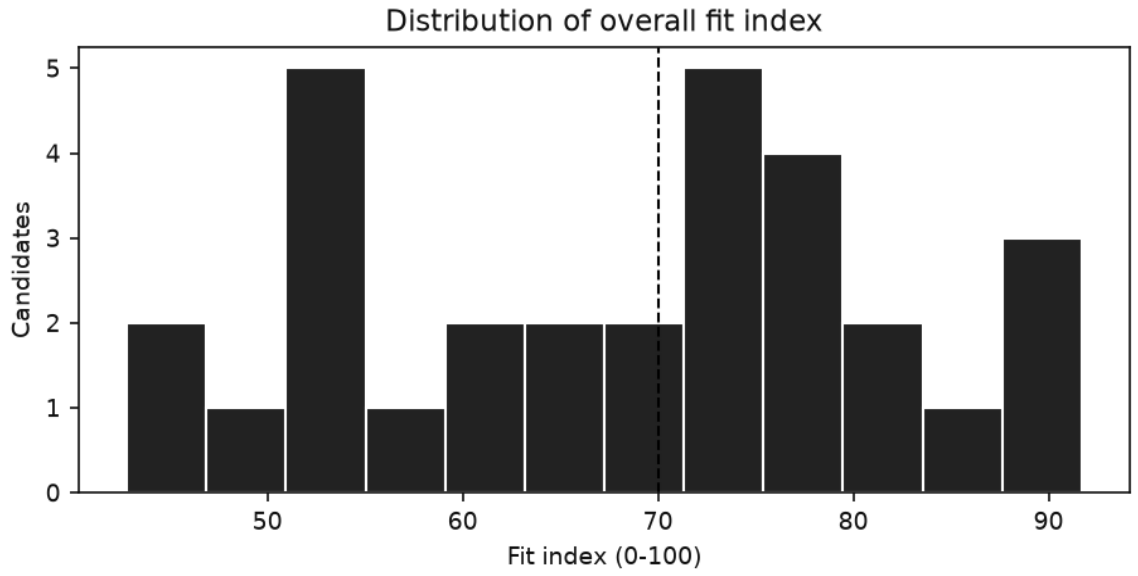


Figure 1. Distribution of the overall fit index.

5.3 Component attainment

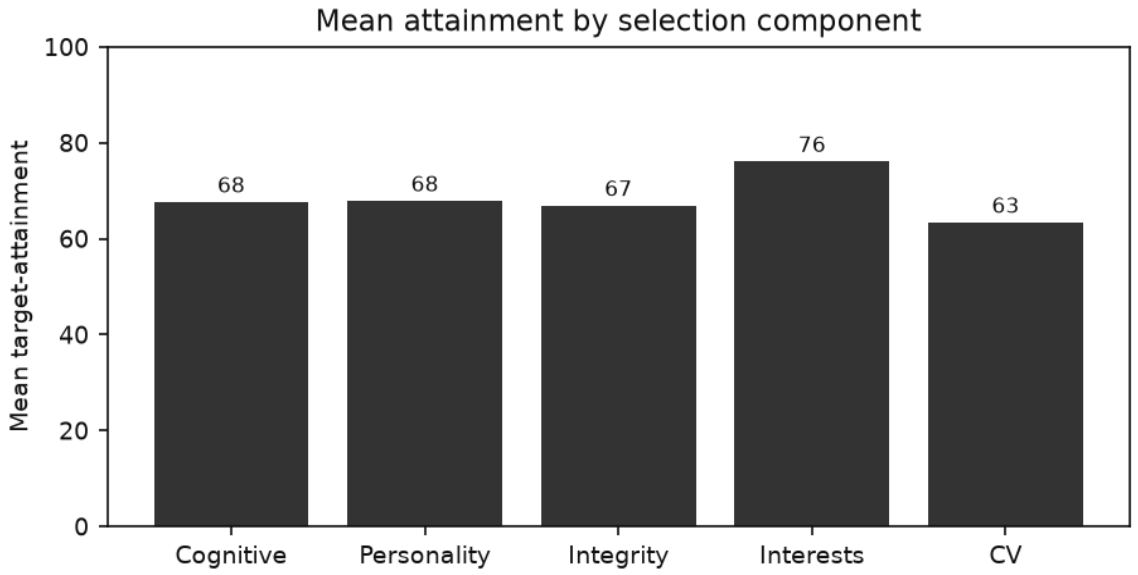


Figure 2. Mean target-attainment by selection component.

Component	Weight	Mean	r with fit
Cognitive ability (ICAR)	20%	67.7	0.72
Personality (IPIP-NEO-120)	35%	67.9	0.64
Integrity (Honesty-Humility)	20%	66.9	0.31
Vocational interests (O*NET)	15%	76.1	0.53
CV & documentation	10%	63.4	0.32

5.4 Personality vs target bands

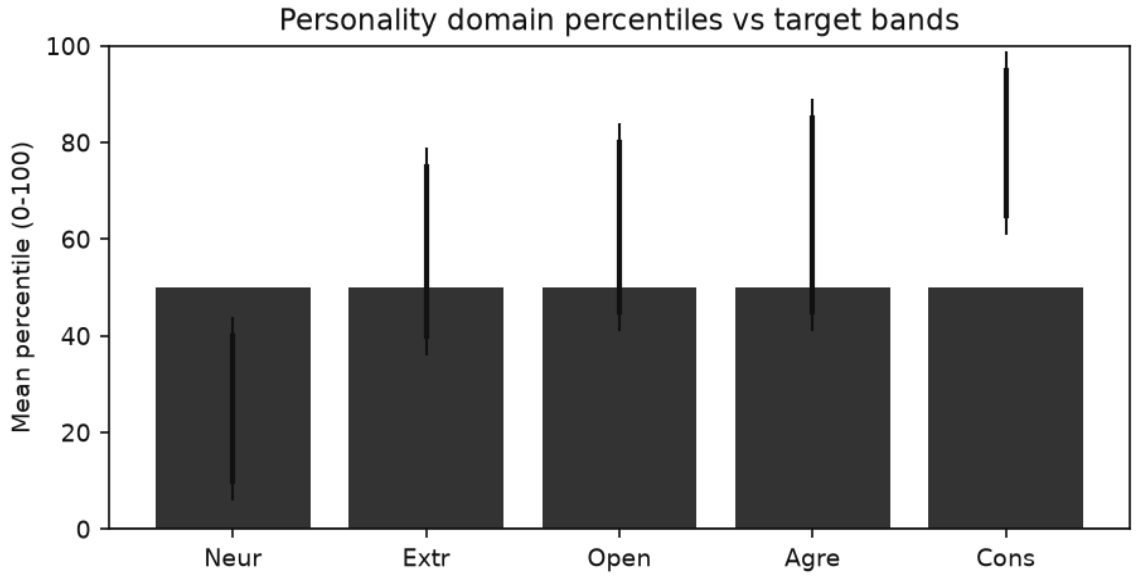


Figure 3. Personality domain percentiles vs target bands.

Domain	Mean pct	Share in target	Target band
Neuroticism	50.0	30%	10-40
Extraversion	50.0	33%	40-75
Openness	50.0	33%	45-80
Agreeableness	50.0	33%	45-85
Conscientiousness	50.0	30%	65-95

5.5 Integrity & 5.6 Vocational interests

Integrity (Honesty-Humility) averages 2.85/5; 33% of candidates reach the P65 target zone. The pool's mean RIASEC profile: R 2.3, I 2.8, A 2.6, S 3.2, E 3.3, C 3.1, consistent with the role's ESC-dominant target. Dominant Holland codes: ECS (6), ESI (2), SCE (2).

5.7 Key relationships

Cognitive ability correlates most strongly with fit (r = 0.72); personality r = 0.64; integrity r = 0.31. CV/documentation alone (r = 0.32) and experience (r = 0.48) are weak predictors of the final recommendation.

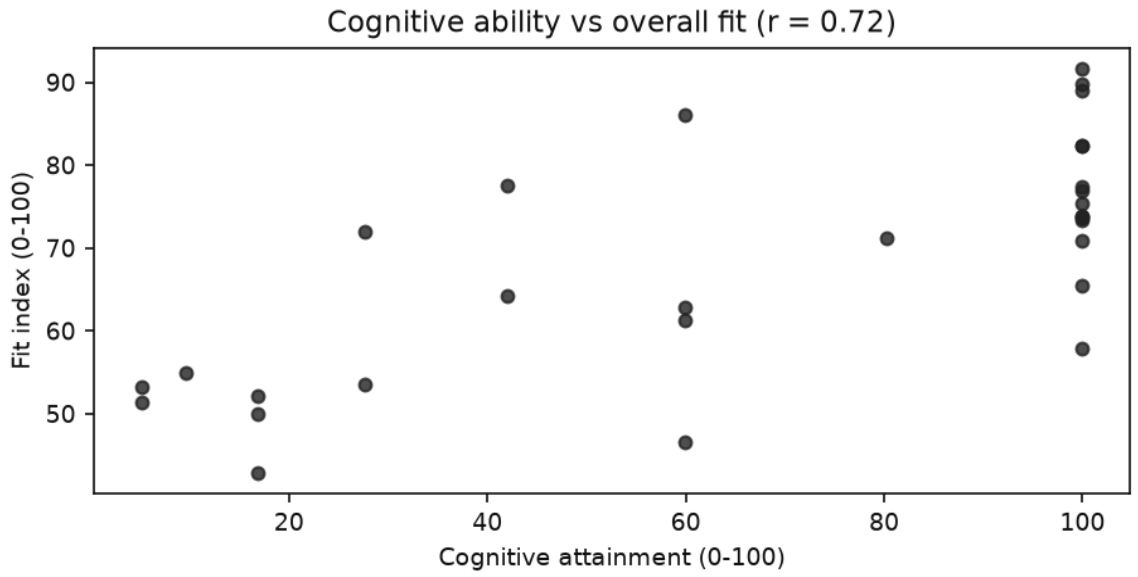


Figure 4. Cognitive attainment vs overall fit.

6. Selection recommendation

The recommendation is based exclusively on the results of this process - psychometric scores, structured interviews and the assessment center - weighted by the profile defined for the role. Three distinct profiles are recommended for hiring.

	First choice	Behavioral	Growth
Fit index	91.7	73.6	82.3
Cognitive	100.0	100.0	100.0
Personality	92.2	58.8	66.1
Integrity	87.5	55.7	87.5
Interests	100.0	100.0	100.0
CV	69.3	69.1	66.5
Assessment center	2.7	3.6	3.4
Years	7.5	6.2	3.0

6.1 Fernanda Aguilar - First choice - best overall fit

Fit index 91.7/100 (High); assessment center 2.7/5.0; Holland code ESC; 8 years; 3 certifications.

Why this recommendation. Highest combined evidence in the process (fit 91.7/100), with a balanced profile and consistent signals across the psychometric battery, interviews and assessment center. Recommended as the primary offer.

Psychological profile. ESC interest profile; conscientiousness very high; emotional regulation robust; collaborative style moderate.

Assessment center. Assessment center (case: campaign launch under scope and budget pressure): overall 2.7/5.0. Standouts: Adaptability, Planning and Organization. Growth areas: Financial Awareness, Stakeholder Communication. Behavior in the group and individual exercises was consistent with the psychometric profile.

Primary watch-out. CV attainment is the weakest component (69/100); it should be managed consciously in the first months.

6.2 Alejandra Perez - Strongest behavioral profile

Fit index 73.6/100 (High); assessment center 3.6/5.0; Holland code ECS; 6 years; 1 certifications.

Why this recommendation. Best behavioral evidence in the assessment center (3.6/5.0) within a solid overall fit (73.6/100). Recommended when stakeholder handling, execution and team integration carry the greatest weight.

Psychological profile. ECS interest profile; conscientiousness low; emotional regulation robust; collaborative style high.

Assessment center. Assessment center (case: campaign launch under scope and budget pressure): overall 3.6/5.0. Standouts: Planning and Organization, Client Orientation. Growth areas: Team Leadership, Problem Solving. Behavior in the group and individual exercises was consistent with the psychometric profile.

Primary watch-out. Integrity attainment is the weakest component (56/100); it should be managed consciously in the first months.

6.3 Gabriela Perez - Highest growth potential

Fit index 82.3/100 (High); assessment center 3.4/5.0; Holland code SCE; 3 years; 4 certifications.

Why this recommendation. Highest cognitive ability in the viable pool (ICAR percentile 95) combined with a strong fit index (82.3/100); the best option to grow into senior or program responsibility within 12-24 months while delivering immediately.

Psychological profile. SCE interest profile; conscientiousness low; emotional regulation developing; collaborative style high.

Assessment center. Assessment center (case: campaign launch under scope and budget pressure): overall 3.4/5.0. Standouts: Client Orientation, Adaptability. Growth areas: Stakeholder Communication, Team Leadership. Behavior in the group and individual exercises was consistent with the psychometric profile.

Primary watch-out. Personality attainment is the weakest component (66/100); it should be managed consciously in the first months.

7. Next steps

• Make the offer to the first choice; notify the other two finalists that they remain contenders if the first offer is declined - all three are offer-viable.

• Agree the start date and a 90-day plan: portfolio ownership, live client dashboards and delivery KPIs.

• Revisit this dashboard six months after hiring to recalibrate weights and bands with performance data.